

The Noble Dhāraṇī That Clears Away Obstacles

Āryavighnavināyakāradhāraṇī · Toh 655 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་བགགས་སལ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī That Clears Away Obstacles, known in Sanskrit as the Āryavighnavināyakāradhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phags pa bgegs sel ba'i gzungs, is a short dhāraṇī text focused on the removal of obstacles and the accomplishment of rites, intentions, and secret mantras through the recitation of a sacred mantra formula. The text follows a classic sūtra framing, opening with the Buddha addressing his attendant Ānanda at the Jeta Grove in Śrāvastī before presenting the dhāraṇī and its benefits, including instructions for daily practice beginning at dawn. It belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of Buddhist canonical literature, in which concentrated sequences of sacred syllables are transmitted as powerful means of protection and spiritual attainment. This text is Toh 655 in the Kangyur, preserved among the dhāraṇī collections of the Tibetan Buddhist canon.

Requested and established in final form.

In the Indian language: Āryavighnavināyakāradhāraṇī. In the Tibetan language: The Noble Dhāraṇī That Clears Away Obstacles.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada. At that time the Blessed One addressed the venerable Ānanda:

"Ānanda, whoever holds the essence of the Lord of the Assembly — that person will accomplish all rites and all intentions. All secret mantras will be accomplished.

"Thus it is: namostu te, kaṭa kaṭa, maṭa maṭa, dara dara, ḍaha ḍaha, gr̥ṇa, bhañja bhañja, namostu te, ruru cacaye svāhā, abhūtrā, vinaduḥkhan mantseddha para samagacchati, hahaya, mahāhastikṣatanana, pragobaye mo, kuru kuru, curu curu, muru muru, namo namaḥ svāhā.

"Rising at dawn, recite this mantra seven times. Take a vessel of water and scatter it in the directions above and below, and all obstacles will be bound. One who wishes to accomplish secret mantras should tie twenty-one knots in a white thread and bind it to the arm — the knowledge mantra will be accomplished and all obstacles will be bound. In whatever place the Lord of the Assembly appears, if this mantra is read even once, the obstacles will not cause harm."

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the entire assembly was filled with joy, and the world together with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

The Noble Dhāraṇī That Clears Away Obstacles is complete.

Furthermore, if one is enveloped in the smoke produced by burning yellow bdellium resin and the thick refuse of wheat, mixed with the stabilizing substance that repels all thieves, then even if one enters the presence of a person stricken with a contagious illness, one will not be infected. If it touches a wound, it quickly heals it. For harmful spirits causing harm in the home it is greatly praised.

Translator's Notes

- The final paragraph is a colophonic addendum in a different register from the sūtra body — a practical application note appended to the dhāraṇī text, likely added by a later Tibetan compiler or scribe. It is not part of the canonical sūtra proper.

The mantra syllables in the body of the text are transliterated Tibetan renderings of Sanskrit and are reproduced here in reconstructed Sanskrit phonetic form as is standard for dhāraṇī texts. Some syllables are corrupt or otherwise difficult to analyze with certainty; the transliteration follows the Tibetan phonetic representation as closely as possible.

The term "Lord of the Assembly" renders Tibetan tshogs kyi bdag po, which here almost certainly refers to Gaṇapati (Gaṇeśa), the deity also called Vighneśvara, the remover of obstacles — which matches the Sanskrit title Vighnavināyakāra of the dhāraṇī. The dhāraṇī is thus simultaneously addressed to and concerned with this deity.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.